destruction—is the one for which the Holocaust historian Saul Friedländer coined the term "redemptive antisemitism." It is not so far from that expressed in a Nazi directive of 1943: "This war will end with antisemitic world revolution and with the extermination of Jewry throughout the world, both of which are the precondition for an enduring peace."[49]

Iran's hatred of Israel resembles Hitler's ideology in this crucial respect: both have a utopian element. Just as Hitler's "German peace" required the extermination of the Jews, so the Iranian leadership's "Islamic peace" depends on the elimination of Israel.

This revolutionary world view leads to action, as the recent war in Gaza confirmed: "The military performance of Hamas in the current war in 2014," stated a former member of the Iranian Parliament, had

> Iranian fingerprints all over it in an indisputable manner, especially in terms of training of fighters on the methods of combat, qualification and transfer of knowledge and technological-executive skills to be used to produce and develop weapons, and the quality improvement of rockets fired towards Israel.[50]

The term "antisemitic" also has a historical dimension; it calls to mind the massive scale of the crime against the Jews during World War II. To speak of antisemitism is to recall the dangers associated with this monstrous irrationality. It means to mobilize not only our historical knowledge but also our historical responsibility.

We have seen that even the world's worst antisemites do not want to be called antisemites; that the term "antisemitism" still carries an extremely negative connotation. We know, at the same time, that policymakers and journalists wish to consider Iran a normal state and therefore they tend to neglect the inconvenient evidence of its ideological fanaticism. Yet ignoring reality does not make it disappear.

The refusal to call antisemitism by its name represents a failure of imagination and a failure of policy: trivialization takes the place of enlightenment, silent acceptance replaces mobilization.

The absence of clarity, however, is the beginning of complicity. This was obvious again when, in July 2014, Ali Khamenei called for Israel's "annihilation and liquidation" and the Western powers remained silent. They accepted the fact that a powerful and nuclear-capable country is advocating and preparing the destruction of Israel. In so doing they harmed not only Israel but also themselves. For Ali Khamenei ended his diatribe about "Israel's wolf-like and child-killer regime" with an attack on the entire free world: "The roots of the defense of the crimes of the Zionists [lies] in the democratic and liberal regimes and in the logic of the most minimal moral

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Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,